PayFast Sandbox Verification

MedMap booking-fee checkout | End-to-end hosted test | 15 October 2026

VERIFIED - SANDBOX ONLY Hosted PayFast virtual payment and callback succeeded. No real money was charged.

Test result

Check	Observed result
Gateway	PayFast sandbox checkout displayed a R10.00 booking fee.
Callback	Render accepted the real PayFast ITN after sender, signature, merchant and amount checks and PayFast VALID postback.
Booking state	MedMap success page showed Sandbox booking fee confirmed; authenticated history showed Confirmed / Paid.
Cancel and retry	Cancellation return and retry were exercised. The paid test booking was cancelled; refund_pending was queued and the test slot was released.
Real charge	None. This was a virtual sandbox payment; live mode remains disabled.

Verified flow

Signed checkout form, then PayFast sandbox virtual wallet, then PayFast ITN, source and signature validation, PayFast server postback validation, Firestore payment and booking update, and MedMap confirmation and booking history.

The API was also tested independently with the actual payment service and a Firestore emulator. That synthetic test passed through the same PayFast sandbox and genuine ITN flow.

What was completed

Changes pushed to the main branch and automatically deployed to the hosted app and booking service.

Gateway and booking safety

- Sandbox-only PayFast checkout with a fixed R10 booking fee and public test account configuration.

- Server-derived patient, doctor and consultation data; authenticated ownership checks; test bookings explicitly labelled and blocked from converting real bookings.

- ITN validation for signature, merchant, amount, gateway payment ID, PayFast source address and the gateway VALID response.

- Idempotent and late callback handling, atomic cancellation and slot release, with manual refund queueing for sandbox payments.

- Authenticated booking history, retry and return pages; local calendar date handling; correct MedMap return origin.

- Render callback sender detection uses its managed Cloudflare client IP header and fails closed if it is missing.

Verification and delivery

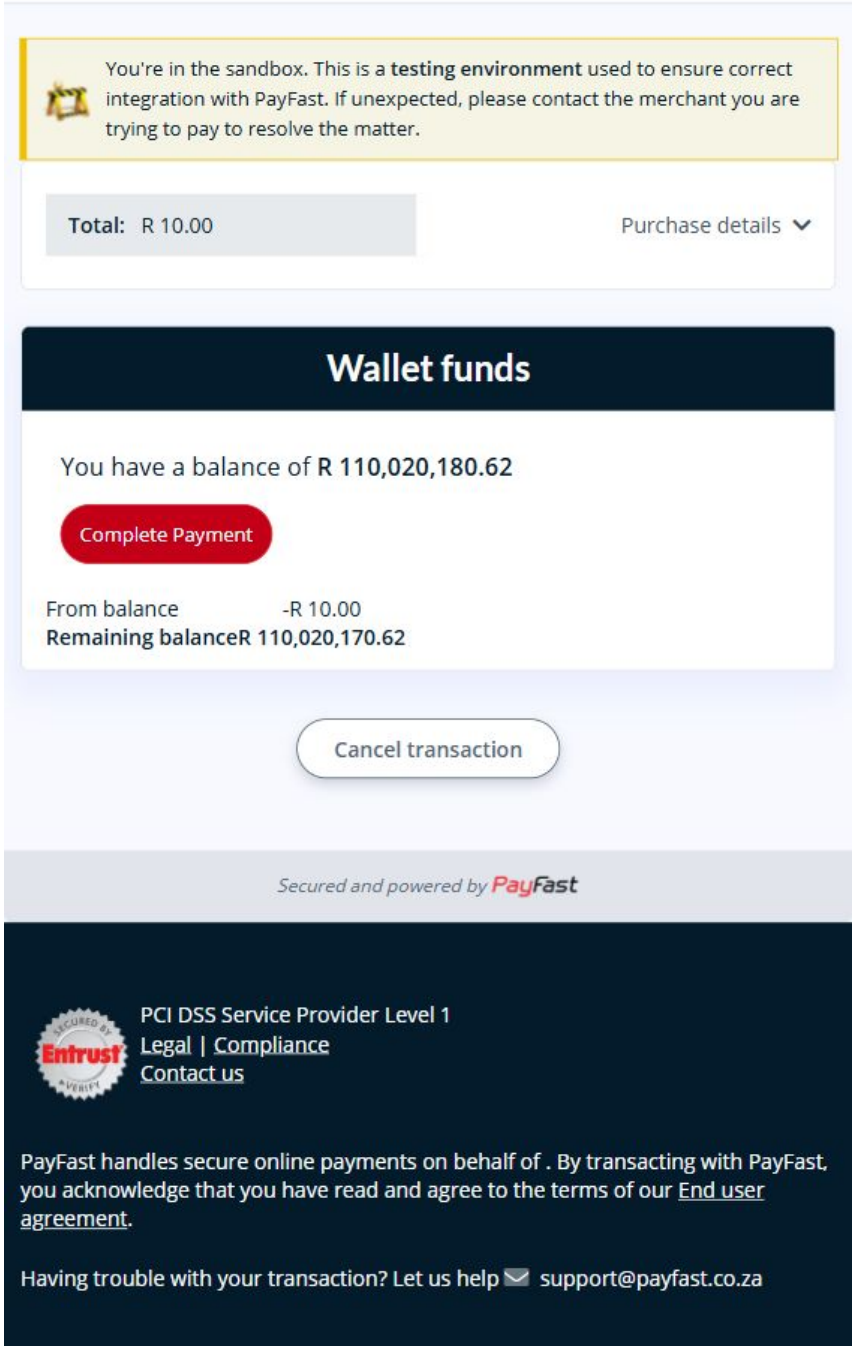
Backend regression suite	29 passed; zero failed
Booking-service TypeScript	Passed
Frontend production build	Passed
Latest commit	e1407f6 - cleanup controls limited to confirmed sandbox test bookings
Payment implementation commits	b748a99, 9c10d03, 891c304 and eea96b7 are also on main

Limits and follow-up

Live payments and live merchant credentials were not enabled or tested. The sandbox refund is queued for manual handling; the integration does not send an actual refund. Existing frontend type and lint diagnostics remain in the repository. GitHub reported dependency advisories during the push; review the current Dependabot alerts before production. The Netlify dashboard showed an overdue $9 invoice and a suspension warning; resolve billing to avoid an interruption.

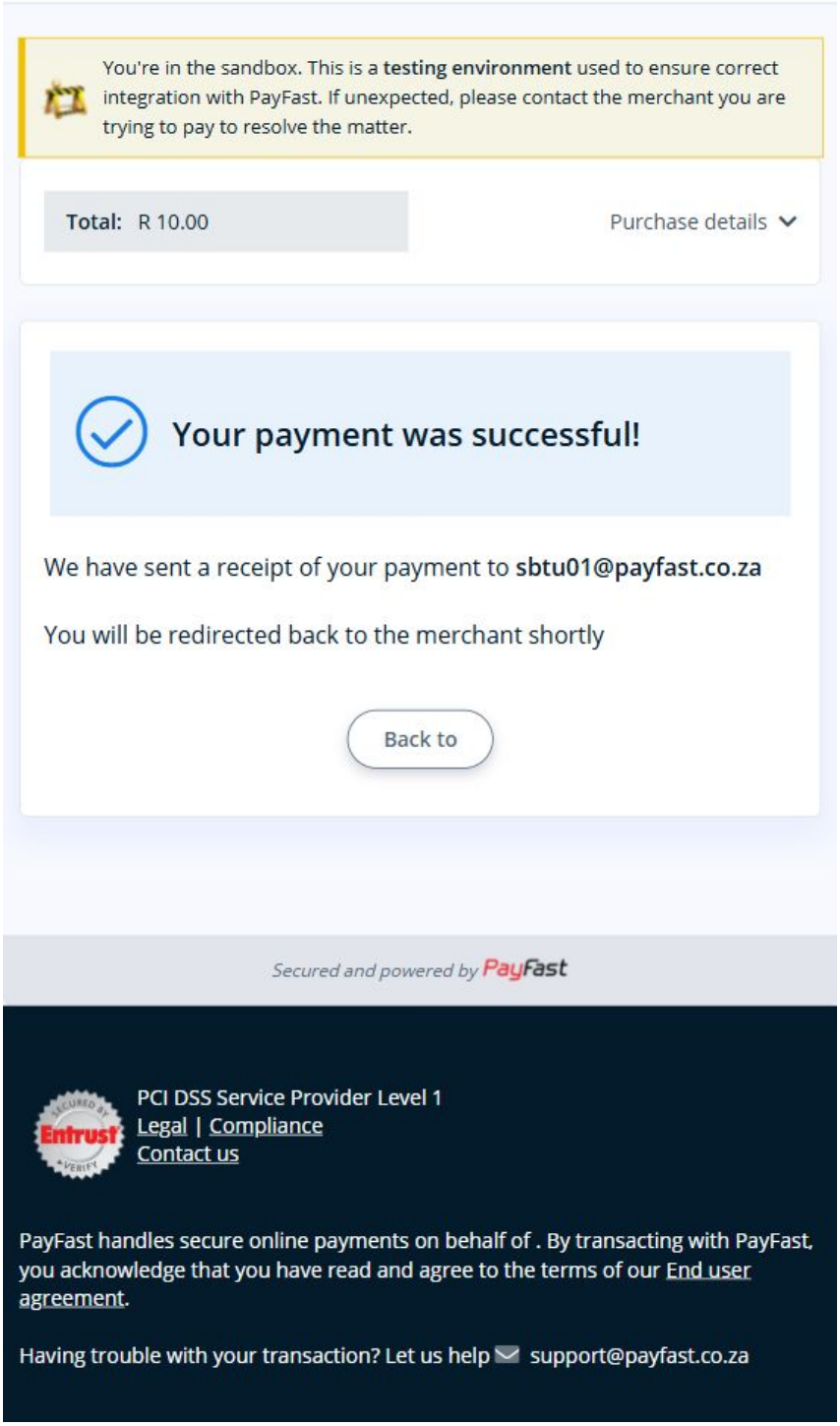
PayFast sandbox checkout

The hosted checkout clearly showed the R10.00 total and the PayFast sandbox notice.



PayFast virtual payment success

PayFast reported that the virtual sandbox payment succeeded and returned to the merchant.



MedMap booking confirmation

After the validated callback, MedMap displayed the sandbox booking fee confirmed state.

